

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4 3
♥ 5
♦ 8 6 5 2
♣ J 10 9 4

♠ 7 5 2

♥ A 10 8

♦ A 9 3

♣ A Q 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8

♥ K Q J 9 6 3

♦ 10 4

♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K Q 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ K 5

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♥K.

As usual, you have 11 winners; 3 ♠s, 1 ♥, 4 ♦s and 3 ♣s. If ♠s split 3-3 dummy's ♠6 will become trick #12. If ♠s don't split though, you will have the chance of a squeeze if the defender with long ♠s also has 4 or more ♣s.

For a squeeze to operate you will need to lose one trick and the time to do that is right now. Let East hold the ♥K and win his ♥ continuation with your ♥A.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	2 ♥	Dbl
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North

Too bad, East discards a ♥ on the third round of ♠s.

West discarded a ♦ on the second ♥.

You might as well find out about the ♠s right now. Play the ♠ A K Q.

West now holds the the only guard in ♠s.

Play the ♦ A, then ♦ K Q.

West will follow to all three ♦s.

Now for the squeeze. Play dummy's ♦J and discard your ♥10.

If West discards the ♠J you will cash dummy's ♠6, then win the last 3 ♣ tricks.

So West will no doubt throw a ♣ instead. In which case you win the last 4 ♣ tricks.

Squeezes are so very satisfying.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 7 3
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ 3 2
♣ 10 9 5

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 2

♦ Q 8 6 4

♣ K Q 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 8 6 4

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 10

♣ J 8 6 3

♠ A

♥ J 7 4

♦ A K J 9 7 5

♣ A 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4 ♦
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	6 ♦
All Pass			

6 ♦ by South

Now play ♦ Q, ♦ J, ♦ 9. Discard the ♠ 5 from dummy on the third ♦.

[showcards N:SQ,HA,H8 E:SJ,S9,H9 S:HJ,H7,D7 W:SK,HQ,HT]

West could afford to throw 2 ♠ s and a ♥ on your ♦ plays.

But when you play the ♦ 7 he is squeezed.

He cannot dump his ♠ K because you would throw the ♥ 8 and dummy would be high.

So he will discard the ♥ 10 instead. At this point you know that the ♠ Q is worthless so you discard it. You win the final two tricks with the ♥ A and ♥ J.

South is to play 6 ♦. West leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 winners; 1 ♠, 1 ♥, 6 ♦ s and 3 ♣ s.

At first things look hopeless, but remember this is a lesson on squeeze plays. From the opening lead you know that West must hold the ♥ Q. If he also holds the ♠ K you will be able to squeeze him in ♥ s and ♠ s.

You let the ♥ K win, (hoping he will play another ♥), but he plays a small trump instead which you win in your hand.

Pull one more round of trumps, then unblock the ♠ A.

Then take your 3 ♣ winners, ending in your hand.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 10 9 3
♥ 10 5 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A K Q

♠ 8 7

♥ A Q 9 8 6 2

♦ Q 7

♣ 7 5 2

 N
W E
 S

♠ 6 5 4 2

♥ J

♦ 9 8 4 3

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ A K J

♥ K 7 3

♦ A 6 5 2

♣ 8 6 4

West

1NT

All Pass

4♥ by North
rectified.

North

2♥

East

Pass

South

4♥

North is to play 4♥. East leads the ♣J. West wins
♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

West takes ♣ A K Q then switches to a trump.

You must win the next 10 tricks but you only have 9 winners.

West opened 1NT, showing 15-17 points, and East has already produced 2 Jacks. So both the ♠Q and ♦K are with West and you will have to put the squeeze on him.

You are in dummy, having won their trump exit with the ♥K.

Since you need all the tricks the count is already

You plan to squeeze West by running the long ♥s in your hand, but the problem is that the ♦Q is not a Threat card yet. To make it a Threat you need to unblock dummy's ♦A. So play the ♦A, then pull trumps with the ♥A Q.

Unblocking the ♦A to make your ♦Q a squeeze Threat is called the Vienna Coup.

With 6 cards left to be played you are ready to apply pressure to West.

Play the ♥9 8, discarding ♦s from dummy. West is not troubled yet, he can discard the ♦J and the ♠3.

[showcards N:SA,SK,SJ,D6 E:SQ,ST,S9,DK S:S8,S7,H6,DQ W:S6,S5,D9,D8]

West is now looking a little nervous, like he has a big target on his back!

Play the ♥6 and throw dummy's ♦6.

West can choose his fate. If he throws the ♠9 you will know that his ♠Q will drop since his third card **MUST** be the ♦K. So you would just play to the high ♠s and the ♠J would be good.

Or, he can throw his ♦K which makes your ♦Q a winner.

That worked great, right? Let's back up and pretend you had NOT unblocked the ♦A. We will just add one ♦ to everybody's hand and look at the ending.

Now when you play your ♥6 as a squeeze card you have a problem. You are squeezing dummy, not West.

If you discard the ♦6 West will throw his ♦J, then sit back and wait for his ♠Q trick.

But if you discard dummy's ♠J instead, West will match that by throwing his ♠9, then sit back and wait for his ♦K trick.

Only by visualizing the ending and using the Vienna Coup can this hand be made.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 5

♥ K Q J 7 5

♦ 9 2

♣ 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ K Q 10 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ -

♠ Q 7

♥ A 4

♦ Q 5 4

♣ A J 9 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6 ♣
All Pass			

6 ♣ by South

Unblocking the ♠ A to create a Threat out of your ♠ Q is the Vienna Coup.

As you see, East was able to find discards on your first three trump leads, but when you play the ♣ 7 and discard dummy's ♠ 2 he is squeezed.

He can see that if he discards a ♦ dummy will be high, so he will probably throw the ♠ K in hopes that his partner holds the ♠ Q. But you have that card and you make the slam.

As an afterthought to this Deal, let us suppose you were playing 6NT rather than 6 ♣.

The only difference would be that to rectify the count you would have to hold up once on the opening ♥ K.

South is to play 6 ♣. West leads the ♥ K.

You have 11 top tricks and hope for a 3-3 ♦ split to give you one more. If they don't split you can hope that the defender with 4 ♦ s also holds the ♠ K and that a squeeze will be possible.

In case the squeeze becomes necessary you should rectify the count, so you win the first trick, pull trumps in two rounds, then give up a ♥ trick.

West takes the ♥ trick and plays the ♦ 9 which you win with your ♦ Q.

You now make the key play of taking dummy's ♠ A before running three rounds of ♣ s.

[showcards N:S2,DA,DK,D8 E:SK,DJ,DT,D7 S:SQ,D5,D4,C7 W:SJ,ST,HQ,D2]